

BUAD 405 Applied Econometrics - Summer '26

Course R Project - Setup & Workflow Guide

This guide walks you through setting up your course R Project on Posit Cloud **once**, and how you will use that same project for every tutorial and assignment for the rest of the term - in the lab and from home.

1. Understanding the project structure

You will download one project folder, `BUAD405_Applied_Econometrics`, at the start of Tutorial 1. This is the **only** project you will use all term - you do not create a new one for each tutorial.

Item	Purpose
README.md	Course project overview - what the project is for and how it's organised. Read it once at the start.
00_setup.R	Run this once , right after opening the project for the first time. It loads/installs every R package used across the term, so you don't repeat this setup each tutorial.
data/	All datasets and codebooks provided by your TA live here. Do not edit files in this folder directly - read from them in your scripts.
scripts/	Your working scripts. Each tutorial's starter script goes here in its own subfolder (see Section 4).
output/figures/	Plots you save from your scripts (e.g. via <code>png()</code> or <code>ggsave()</code>).
output/tables/	Summary tables or cleaned data exports you save from your scripts.
submissions/tutorials/	Your final tutorial script, renamed and placed here when you submit (Section 5).
submissions/assignments /	Your final assignment script, renamed and placed here when you submit (Section 5).

2. One-time setup (do this before Tutorial 1)

Step 1 - Create a Posit Cloud account

Go to **posit.cloud** and sign up for a free account (or join the course workspace if a link is shared with you). This account is where all your work will live for the rest of the term, so use an email/password you'll remember.

Step 2 - Download the project folder

Download `Applied_Econometrics_S26.zip` from the link your TA shares. Keep it zipped for now.

Step 3 - Create a blank project on Posit Cloud

In Posit Cloud, click **New Project** → **New RStudio Project**. This opens an empty RStudio session in your browser.

Step 4 - Upload and extract the project folder

- In the **Files** pane (bottom-right), click **Upload**.
- Select `Applied_Econometrics_S26.zip` and upload it.
- Once uploaded, tick its checkbox → click **More** (gear icon) → **Extract** (or run `unzip("Applied_Econometrics_S26.zip")` in the Console if no Extract option appears).
- Delete the .zip file afterward to keep things tidy (tick it → the trash icon).

Step 5 - Confirm the structure

In the Files pane, open the extracted `Applied_Econometrics_S26` folder and confirm you see `data/`, `scripts/`, `output/`, and `submissions/` exactly as in Section 1.

Step 6 - Run the setup script once

Open `00_setup.R` and click **Source** at the top of the script pane. Let it finish completely before moving on - this installs everything you'll need for the rest of the course.

3. Working through Tutorial 1

- Open `scripts/tutorial01_starter.R`.
- Work through it alongside the Tutorial 1 handout, filling in each blank.
- Save any plot you're asked to produce into `output/figures/` (e.g. `tutorial01_life_expectancy_gdp.png`).
- Save any table you're asked to produce into `output/tables/`.
- Compare your own output against `scripts/tutorial01_expected_outputs.pdf` as you go, not just at the end.

4. Submission - naming convention & where files go

Before submitting, make a renamed **copy** of your finished script - do not rename your working copy in `scripts/`, keep that as your working file.

Type	File name pattern	Goes in
Tutorial	<code>tutorial01_yourname_ID.R</code>	<code>submissions/tutorials/</code>
Assignment	<code>assignment01_yourname_ID.R</code>	<code>submissions/assignments/</code>

Example: if your name is Naeem Hossam and your student ID is 34-1234, your Tutorial 1 submission file is `tutorial01_naeemhossam_341234.R`, placed in `submissions/tutorials/`. Use lowercase, no spaces, and your name exactly as it appears on the class roster.

5. How this works in future tutorials

The project itself does not change or get re-downloaded after Tutorial 1. For each new tutorial:

- Your TA will share a new starter script (e.g. `tutorial02_starter.R`) separately, since it can't be added to a project you've already downloaded.
- Inside `scripts/`, create a new subfolder for that tutorial number (e.g. `scripts/tutorial02/`) and place the new starter script there.
- Do the same for outputs: e.g. `output/figures/tutorial02/` and `output/tables/tutorial02/`, so figures from different tutorials don't overwrite each other.
- Submissions still follow the pattern in Section 4, just with the matching tutorial or assignment number.

By the end of the course, your one project will contain a complete, organised record of every tutorial and assignment you did - useful for your own revision, and if you ever need to show your work.

6. Working from home (and back in the lab)

Because everything lives on Posit Cloud rather than on one computer, you do **not** need to re-download or re-upload anything to keep working.

- At home: go to **posit.cloud**, log in, and open `Applied_Econometrics_S26` from your project list.
- Everything you saved last time - scripts, figures, tables - is exactly as you left it.
- Back in the lab: log in on the lab computer and open the same project again. There is only ever one copy, so there's nothing to keep in sync manually.

7. Quick checklist before you start any tutorial

- Project open, title bar shows `BUAD405_Applied_Econometrics.Rproj`.
- Correct tutorial's starter script open from its `scripts/` subfolder.
- Tutorial handout open alongside it.
- Know where this tutorial's figures/tables should be saved before you start coding.